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FREE WORKBOOK · 2026 EDITION

Your Email Marketing Onboarding Kit for eCommerce Beginners

Launch your eCommerce email marketing with our simple onboarding kit. Get started with essential ecommerce email templates and a clear 3–step plan for beginners.



5 pages · PDF

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What's inside

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The real secret to long-term success in any business lies in turning that first-time buyer into a repeat customer. The best way to do that? Email marketing. It might sound complicated, but it's simply about having friendly, automated conversations with your customers.

This onboarding kit is your simple, three-step starter pack. It contains the exact tools and ecommerce email templates you need to start building a loyal community from day one.

01 Step 1: Gather Your Essential Tools

Before you write a single email, you need two things: a platform to send from and a way to collect addresses.

- Choose a Beginner-Friendly Email Platform: Don't try to do this from your personal Gmail. Use a tool built for the job. Platforms like Mailchimp, MailerLite, or Moosend are perfect for beginners. They offer free plans, are easy to connect to your online store (like Shopify or WooCommerce), and provide the crucial ecommerce email templates and automation you need.
- Set Up a Simple Sign-Up Form: Your first goal is to build an email list. Place a pop-up or embedded sign-up form on your website. Offer a small incentive, like a 10% discount on their first purchase, in exchange for their email address. This is your foundation for all future lead generation.

02 Step 2: Implement Your Core "Set-and-Forget" Email Flows

This is where the magic happens. Automation flows are pre-written email sequences that trigger based on what a customer does. Set these up once, and they work for you 24/7.

- The Welcome Series: The moment someone subscribes, this series kicks in.
- Email 1: Immediately send a "Thanks for subscribing!" message and deliver their discount code.
- Email 2 (2 days later): Introduce your brand's story and mission. Why did you start this store?
- Email 3 (4 days later): Showcase your three most popular products.
- The Abandoned Cart Flow: This is your sales superhero, for recovering lost revenue.
    - Email 1 (1 hour after cart abandonment): "Did you forget something?" Gently remind them of what they left behind with a clear picture of the product.
    - Email 2 (24 hours later): "Still thinking about it?" Add a bit of urgency or social proof, like "This item is selling fast!"

- Email 3 (3 days later): "Last Chance!" Offer a final, time-sensitive discount to encourage them to complete the purchase.

03 Step 3: Create Your Core Ecommerce Email Templates

Beyond automated flows, you'll need a few go-to templates for manual campaigns. Having these ecommerce email templates ready will save you hours and constant brainstorming.

1. The "New Product Launch" Template: Excitedly announce a new item. Focus on the benefits for the customer and include high-quality images and a clear "Shop Now" button.
2. The "Educational/Value-Based" Newsletter Template: Don’t just sell; provide value. Share tips related to your products. For example, if you sell yoga mats, send a newsletter with "5 Easy Desk Stretches." This builds trust and keeps your brand top-of-mind.
3. The "Seasonal Sale" Announcement Template: For holidays like Black Friday or a summer sale. Create a simple, bold template that clearly states the sale, the discount, and the deadline.

04 Your Action Plan: Start This Week

1. Day 1: Sign up for a free-tier email marketing platform.
2. Day 2: Add a sign-up form with a discount to your website.
3. Day 3: Write and set up your 3-part Welcome Series.
4. Day 4: Build your Abandoned Cart flow.
5. Day 5: Draft your "New Product Launch" template for future use.

Remember, the goal is progress, not perfection. Your emails don't need to be literary masterpieces; they need to be helpful and human. By focusing on these three core areas, you’re not just sending emails, you’re building a system for customer retention and sustainable growth.

Ready to put these templates into action but need help building your store first? At Shopinbos, we guide first-time sellers through every step. Explore our resources to launch your store with confidence!

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Ready to make your first sale?

Rex builds your store with you in 5 minutes. Take card, transfer and pay on delivery, book riders, and let Peggy answer customers on WhatsApp.

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